

Mid-Year Report

Six-Month Review, Full-Year Outlook
& the Acreage Question

Prepared for the Fall Planting Meeting with Chef Philip Tessier

\$48.7K

REVENUE, LAST SIX
MONTHS
(DEC '25 – MAY '26)

91

DELIVERIES
IN THE HALF-YEAR

~\$200K

REVENUE PER
ACRE,
ANNUALIZED (HALF-
ACRE)

Carrots

#1 CROP — 28% OF
HALF-YEAR
REVENUE

The Half-Year at a Glance

Press Farm is a half-acre specialty garden in Yountville supplying Chef Philip Tessier's kitchens. This report covers the **last six months (December 2025 – May 2026)**, sets them against the farm's full history, looks ahead to the rest of 2026 and the years beyond, and answers the question on the table for the fall planting meeting: **does adding acreage help the farm, or not?**

- 1 The half-year delivered \$48.7K across 91 deliveries** — a healthy winter-and-spring run, carried by a standout January (\$19.8K) on the back of a big carrot harvest. The farm enters its strong season (August–November) with momentum.
- 2 The land is already working at an elite intensity.** A half-acre is producing a trailing-twelve-month run rate near \$124K — roughly **\$200K+ per acre**, several times typical specialty-crop benchmarks. The farm is not under-using its ground.
- 3 The binding constraint is labor and harvest capacity, not land.** One grower plus a weekly helper is near the management ceiling of the current half-acre. That single fact is the key to the acreage decision below.

THE BOTTOM LINE FOR THE PLANTING MEETING

Adding raw acreage "on spec" would mostly add weeding and waste, because the farm sells nearly everything it can pick and the limit is hands, not dirt. But **targeted** expansion — a dedicated winter root/brassica block to deepen the proven January pull, planted into leased winery-adjacent ground and staffed by the incoming second hire — pays for itself in under a season. **Expand by crop and by demand, not by the acre.**

01 The Last Six Months in Review

EXHIBIT 1

Monthly revenue, December 2025 – May 2026

Month	Deliveries	Revenue
December 2025	12	\$6,412
January 2026	17	\$19,831
February 2026	10	\$5,911
March 2026	10	\$3,685
April 2026	17	\$5,504
May 2026	25	\$7,350
Six-month total	91	\$48,691

January is the story of the half-year. A large winter carrot harvest drove a \$19.8K month — Carrots alone were \$12.3K of it (3,500+ units). This is not a data quirk; it is a real, repeatable winter cash crop, and it is the single most important planting signal in this report. May's 25 deliveries also show the spring cadence picking back up heading into summer.

1.1 What the kitchen pulled

EXHIBIT 2

Revenue by category, last six months

Category	Revenue	Share
Fruit & vegetables	\$20,160	41%
Herbs & leaves	\$13,364	27%
Flowers	\$13,030	27%
Microgreens	\$1,701	4%
Kits	\$436	1%
Total	\$48,691	100%

EXHIBIT 3

Top crops, last six months — these are your proven winter/spring sellers

Crop	Revenue	Share of half-year
Carrots	\$13,636	28%
Radish	\$5,325	11%
Nasturtium (leaf)	\$4,838	10%
Mustard Flowers	\$3,442	7%
Turnip	\$1,800	4%
Fava	\$1,464	3%
Kale	\$1,400	3%
Nasturtium Flowers · Cauliflower · Lettuce · Alyssum · Citrus · Bay · Yuzu · Fava Leaf	\$5,000+	combined

The top three crops — Carrots, Radish, Nasturtium — were nearly half of the half-year's revenue. This is the menu the kitchen actually reached for through winter and spring, and it is the clearest possible guide to what should go in the ground this fall.

1.2 What it cost

Cash inputs for the six months were **\$10,243** — but \$5,074 of that was equipment (one-time buildout), leaving roughly **\$3,600 in recurring biological inputs** (seed, soil, plants, amendments) against \$48.7K of revenue. In-season margin on what the farm grows remains above 90%. The economics are not the problem; capacity is.

A NOTE ON LABOR IN THE NUMBERS

Labor and grower pay are not yet captured in the system, so these figures are contribution, not fully-loaded net. The fix is cheap — log hours for one month — and it matters before any decision to hire or expand, because labor is precisely the lever this report turns on.

02 Two Houses, One Garden

Press Farm has supplied **both Press and Under-Study since Under-Study opened**. Because deliveries to the two houses have always been booked together under one account, the system cannot yet split how much produce flows to each kitchen — it has been kept, correctly, as one combined relationship.

CORRECTING AN EARLIER READ

An earlier draft of this analysis treated the farm as a "single-account" operation with concentration risk. That was a bookkeeping artifact, not reality. The farm has served two restaurants all along — the revenue simply wasn't tagged by house. The relationship is a **two-venue partnership**, and it is a strength, not a fragility.

The one practical gap this creates is planning: without a per-house split, the farm can't yet see whether Press and Under-Study want different things, or how fast each is growing. That matters directly for fall planting — if the two kitchens pull different crops or volumes, the garden should be planted to serve both menus deliberately.

RECOMMENDATION

Start tagging deliveries by house this fall

Going forward, mark each delivery as Press or Under-Study (the system already supports both as separate restaurants). Within one season this produces a clean per-house demand picture — what each kitchen orders, when, and how much — so the crop plan can be built around two menus instead of an estimate. No back-fixing of history is needed; the split simply starts now.

03 The Longer Arc — Where the Farm Has Been

The half-year sits inside a clear multi-year climb. The farm has grown from a part-year operation into a six-figure run rate in two years.

EXHIBIT 4

Revenue by year

Year	Revenue	Deliveries	Note
2024 (Jul–Dec)	\$34,182	115	First half-year of records
2025 (full year)	\$102,501	209	First six-figure year
2026 (Jan–Jun, partial)	\$44,122	87	Tracking ahead of 2025 pace
Trailing 12 months	~\$124,000	—	Current run rate

Two things stand out. First, **revenue per delivery has risen ~65%** since 2024 — the farm is earning more per drop through premium specialty crops, not by running the truck more often. Second, the year has a strong, dependable shape.

EXHIBIT 5

The shape of the year — average monthly revenue, two-year basis



Dark = peak, light = trough. Two revenue mountains: a summer/early-fall peak (Aug–Sep, ~\$45K of the year across Aug–Nov) and a winter carrot peak (January). The soft spots are February–March and December.

The strategic read is simple: **the farm already knows when its money comes in.** The opportunity is to defend the two peaks (don't run short at the August–September top) and to keep feeding the January carrot peak — which is exactly what fall planting decides.

04 The Rest of 2026

The farm has banked \$44.1K through mid-June and is walking into its biggest months. Three scenarios for the full year, anchored on last year's strong second half (\$75.5K) and current momentum:

EXHIBIT 6

Full-year 2026 scenarios

Scenario	Assumption for Jul-Dec	Full-year 2026	vs 2025
Conservative	Peak underperforms / weather softens	~\$106K	+4%
Most likely	Second half near 2025 with modest growth	~\$122K	+19%
Strong	Peak fully supplied, momentum carries	~\$144K	+41%

The difference between "most likely" and "strong" is almost entirely **whether the August–September peak gets picked and delivered to full demand**. That is a labor-and-planting question, not a sales question — the orders are there in peak season; the limit is hands and harvest-ready crops. **That is what this fall's planting and the second hire are for.**

WHAT TO PLANT THIS FALL — STRAIGHT FROM THE DATA

The crops that carried the last six months *are* the fall planting list: **carrots** (the January engine — plant generously and in succession), **radish & turnip** (fast winter cash), **brassicas** — cauliflower, broccoli, kale, **favas** (corn-field rotation), winter **lettuce**, and the cool-season flowers the kitchen pulls year-round — **nasturtium, mustard flower, alyssum**. Citrus and yuzu from the orchard round out winter. Plant what already sells before planting anything speculative.

05 The Acreage Question

Should Press Farm grow beyond its half-acre? The honest answer depends entirely on *how* — and the data points to a clear yes-with-conditions.

5.1 The farm today

The half-acre is laid out in defined blocks — the corn field (8 rows, corn and fava), the tomato field (22 rows), the field beside the corn (14 rows), the orchard (17 rows), the passionfruit field (15 rows), plus permanent flower rows along the back and sides. Roughly 75+ production rows at 25' × 30", worked by one grower with a weekly helper for weeding.

THE NUMBER THAT FRAMES EVERYTHING

A half-acre is producing a ~\$124K trailing-twelve-month run rate — about \$200,000+ per acre. Typical California specialty-vegetable ground grosses a fraction of that. Intensive market gardens reach \$50–100K per acre. Press Farm is running at **two to four times** that, because it grows high-value garnish and specialty crops for a fine-dining kitchen. The land is not the underused asset.

5.2 Where more acreage helps — and where it doesn't

EXHIBIT 7

The acreage decision matrix

Expansion type	Demand-backed?	Verdict
Winter root & brassica block carrots, radish, turnip, cauliflower, kale	Yes — proven Jan–Mar pull, storable, fills the winter trough	Strong yes
Peak-season flower & herb block nasturtium, marigold, mustard, basil	Yes at the Aug–Sep peak — but only if harvest labor is covered	Yes, if staffed
Perennial expansion more orchard, figs, yuzu, passionfruit	Long payback (years), but on proven sellers	Selective
Generic acreage "on spec" more ground ahead of demand	No — the farm is labor- and demand-limited, not land-limited	No

The logic is the same in every row: **acreage pays when it is matched to a crop the kitchen already buys and to hands that can harvest it.** Acreage added ahead of demand simply converts a 90%-margin crop into weeding hours and compost.

5.3 An illustrative incremental block

To make it concrete — one new ~10-row winter block of carrots and brassicas on leased winery-adjacent ground, succession-planted:

EXHIBIT 8

One added winter block — illustrative economics

Line	Estimate
Incremental revenue / year (benchmarked to current carrot & root sell-through)	\$4,000 – \$7,000
Recurring inputs (seed, amendment)	(\$300 – \$500)
Incremental labor (absorbed by the second hire)	variable
Contribution / year, per block	\$3,500 – \$6,000

Illustrative, not a guarantee — and realized only if the kitchen pulls the crop. The payback on land prep and irrigation for a cheaply-leased block is under one season. Stack two or three such blocks and the math compounds; the ceiling is harvest labor, not land cost.

5.4 The real gate: labor, then land

Two facts from the ground decide this. First, **land may be available through neighboring wineries** — so ground is not the scarce input. Second, **the farm is run by one grower with a Friday helper, and a second hire is already in process**. That hire — not the dirt — is the true unlock. With a second pair of hands, a targeted winter block and a fully-harvested peak both become reachable. Without it, more acreage would stretch one person past the breaking point and revenue would leak as unharvested crop.

THE ACREAGE VERDICT

Lease, don't buy; expand by the block, not the acre; and let the second hire — not the land — set the pace. A dedicated winter carrot/brassica block is the highest-confidence first move: it deepens the proven January peak, stores well, and fills the farm's softest season. Hold off on generic acreage until labor is in place and a per-house demand picture exists.

06 The Years to Come

Growth from here is gated by labor and demand, so these targets are deliberately tied to **crew, growing blocks, and how deliberately the two houses are served** — not to a growth percentage. Hit the inputs and the revenue follows.

EXHIBIT 9

Illustrative path, 2026–2028

Driver	2026 (base)	2027 (target)	2028 (target)
Growing area	0.5 acre	0.5 acre + 1 leased block	~0.75 acre equiv.
Crew	Grower + Fri. helper	Grower + 1 full hire	Grower + 1 + seasonal
Houses served (tracked)	2, blended	2, split by house	2 + events / selective new
Revenue	~\$122K	~\$150K	~\$185K
Winter-month floor	~\$5K	~\$8K	~\$11K

Conservative by design: each step up assumes labor is in place first. The winter-block strategy does double duty — it raises the annual total and lifts the farm's softest months, smoothing cash flow and making Press Farm a steadier year-round supplier to both kitchens.

07 Recommendations

EXHIBIT 10

What to do, in order

#	Action	Horizon
1	Plant the proven sellers this fall — carrots in succession (the January engine), radish, turnip, brassicas, favas, cool-season flowers. Plant what sells before anything speculative.	This meeting
2	Land the second hire — it is the true constraint on both the peak harvest and any expansion.	Now
3	Add one leased winter block for carrots/brassicas once the hire is in — highest-confidence expansion, fills the trough.	Fall–Winter
4	Tag deliveries by house (Press vs Under-Study) starting now, to build a per-kitchen demand picture for next year's plan.	This fall
5	Log labor hours for one month so the next report shows true net, not just contribution.	Immediate
6	Defend the Aug–Sep peak — plan crew and succession plantings now so nothing goes unpicked at the top of the season.	Summer

Methodology & notes. Revenue = realized deliveries and delivery line items (the financial source of truth), not order intent. Figures exclude grower pay and labor, which are not yet captured in the system, so totals are contribution rather than fully-loaded net. Half-year window: December 2025 – May 2026 (six complete months); full history begins July 2024. Press and Under-Study deliveries have historically been booked as one combined account and cannot yet be split by house. Per-acre figures annualize the trailing-twelve-month run rate over the stated half-acre. Forecasts and the incremental-block economics are scenario estimates for planning, built on observed sell-through and seasonality — directional, not guarantees; actuals depend on weather, labor, and kitchen demand. · Press Farm OS, Yountville, CA.